

Internet Resource Guide For Game Developers

By: Joseph Neisen
Technical Writing ENGL-009

Table of Contents

Title Page	... 1
Table of Contents	... 2
List of Figures	... 2
Abstract	... 3
Research Tools For Game Developers	... 4
Fig. 1 GDC Youtube Channel	
GDC Vault	
IEEE Transactions In Games	
Professional Societies	... 6
Fig 2. IGDA events page	
International Game Developers Association (IGDA)	
The Entertainment Software Association (ESA)	
Extra Web Resources	... 8
Fig. 3 Steam Logo with games in background	
Steam	
Tyler Glaiel's Blog	
Fig. 4 Screenshot of Godot Engine	
Godot Game Engine	
Fig. 5 Screenshot of Indie Game Jam's Calendar	
Indie Game Jams Repository	
Appendix	... 11
Scholarships	
Internships	

Abstract

It takes effort to make a career in game development, but it is certainly possible. The most important part for landing a job is a portfolio and this guide is designed to encourage and put you on the path to creating your own. While this is a huge field, with many multidisciplinary studies, including but not limited to music composition, 3D and 2D art, programming, and pure game design, this guide attempts to include resources broad enough to be useful for any sect of game development.

This guide contains research paths for ease of information finding, professional societies that you can utilize to further your career, and various other internet resources that will start you on your journey. The most important part of this early stage of your career is building a portfolio, so that when you enter into the workforce, you have something that stands out from other candidates. It also allows you to do something incredibly fun: make a bunch of games.

This guide is certainly not the end all be all for your early career but is designed as a guiding hand for a game developer who is lost on their journey to create great art. So get out there and make games!

Research Tools for Game Developers



This section provides websites that can be used to research game development in order to identify how to improve as a game developer and use the communities' collective knowledge.

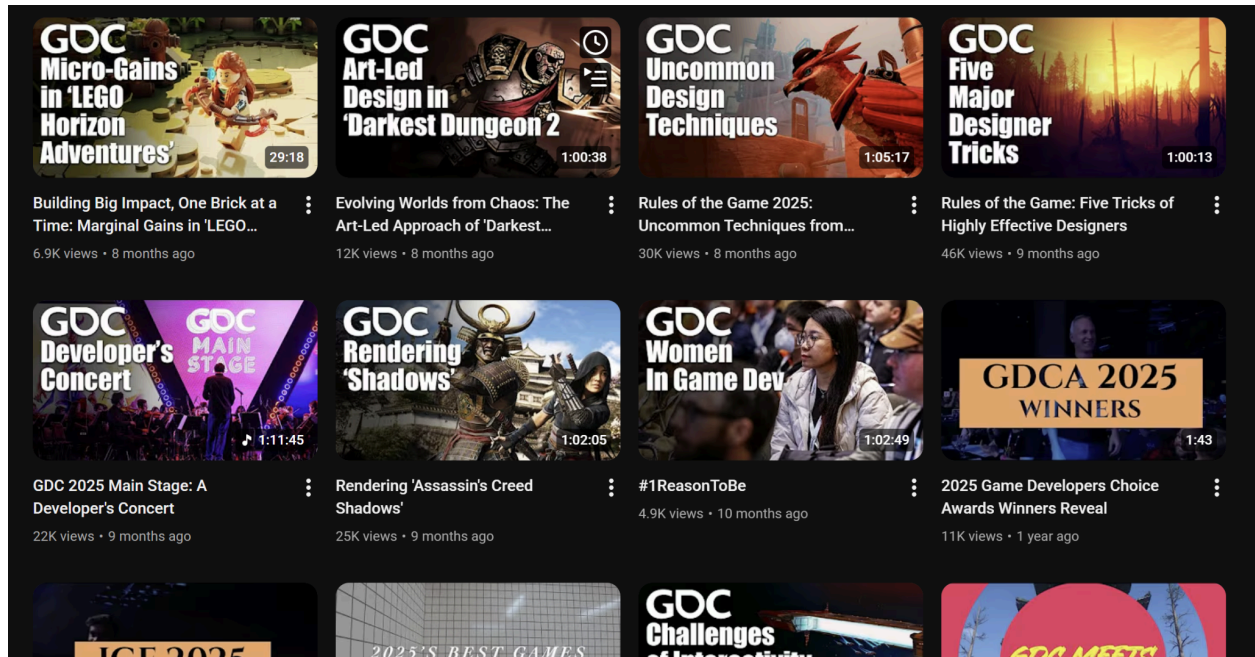


Fig. 1 GDC Youtube Channel

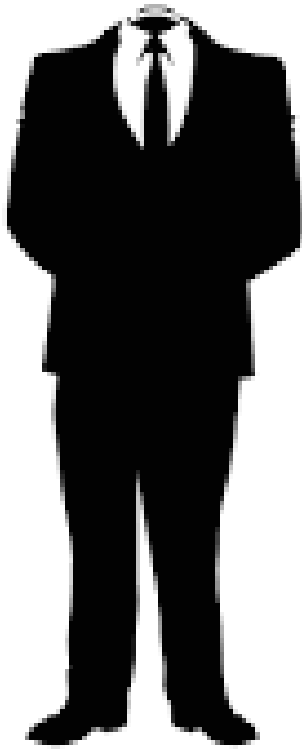
GDC Vault: <https://gdevault.com/>

GDC Vault is a collection of talks from the Game Developer's Conference, the premier conference for game development in the world. The vault stores countless incredibly useful lectures including retrospectives, marketing recommendations, game jam dissections, and many more incredibly useful speeches. Additionally the GDC youtube channel is also a good way to peruse their content

IEEE Transactions on games: <https://transactions.games/>

IEEE Transactions on games offers a much more research focussed database on game, analyzing widespread game trends, improving machine learning within game environments. This is a useful website for gaining interesting insights in the game making world.

Professional Societies



While professional societies are less important than the skills that you possess, leveraging connections within a professional society can allow you to get better jobs and collaborate with more people in the industry.

Upcoming Programs & Events

Fig 2. IGDA events page

International Game Developer's Association - <https://idga.org>

The IGDA advocates for game developers throughout the world and is an amazing place to make connections and further one's career. It additionally hosts talks all over in different chapters, so consider going to one of those (take a look at the events and programs tab on the website for meetings near you). Ultimately a professional society is all about networking so the scale of the IGDA is a huge benefit. Also this society supports unions across companies which is extremely important especially in game development as often workers are not treated or paid very well.

The Entertainment Software Association - <https://theesa.com/>

The ESA is a professional organization which focuses on governmental and wide sweeping changes within game development. They focus on protecting consumers and allowing the games industry to grow and thrive. They additionally spend resources finding out trends in consumer data which are interesting to take a look at.

Extra Web Resources



This section provides a few good extra internet sources that might help you with motivation or what you should focus on at this point in your career. It is arguably the most important part of this resource guide.

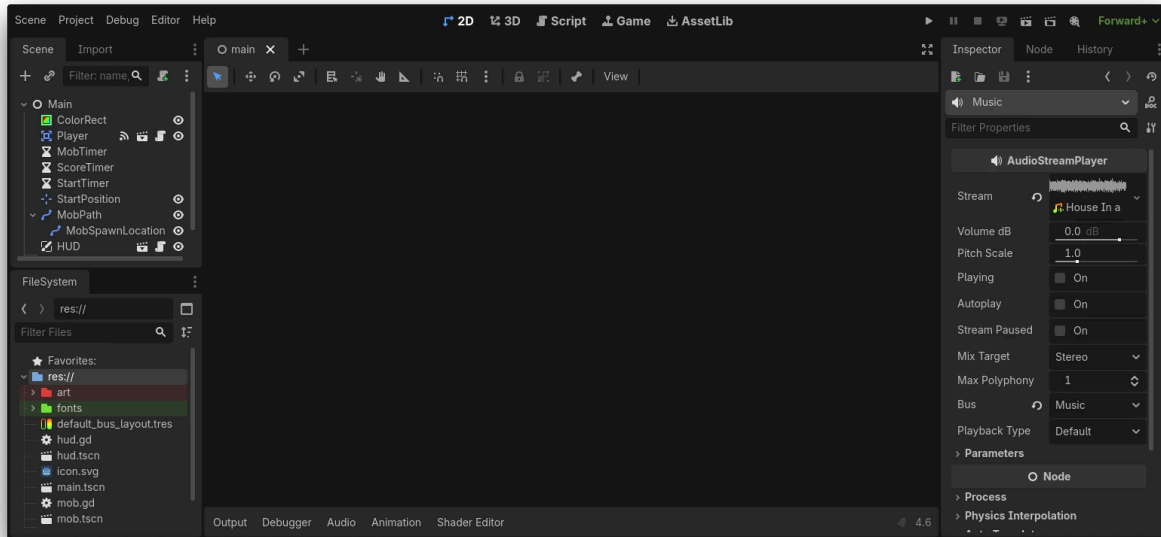


Fig. 4 Screenshot of Godot Engine

Godot Game Engine - <https://godotengine.org/> -

If you don't already have a game engine, you should use Godot for your projects (at least starting out). It is open source and constantly being improved by the people who contribute as well as having pretty much all that you could possibly need. There are quite a few tutorials on how to make games in Godot, so it is a great place to start your development. The documentation and forums are great if you need help on your projects.

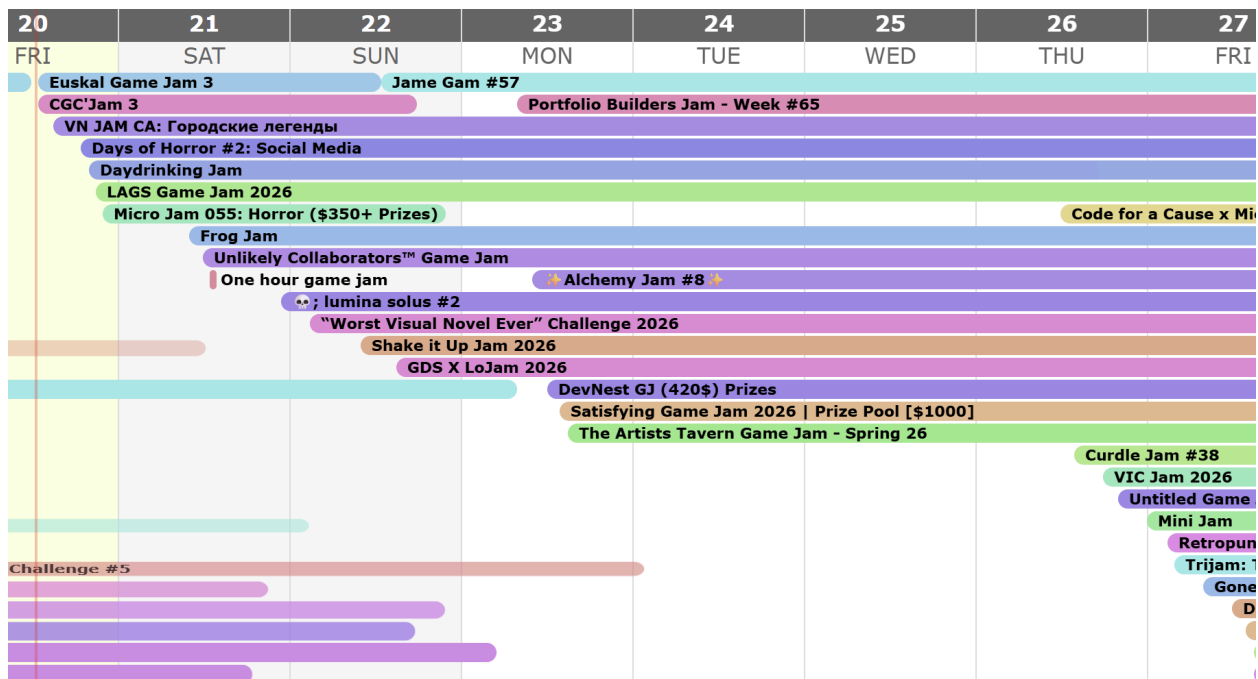


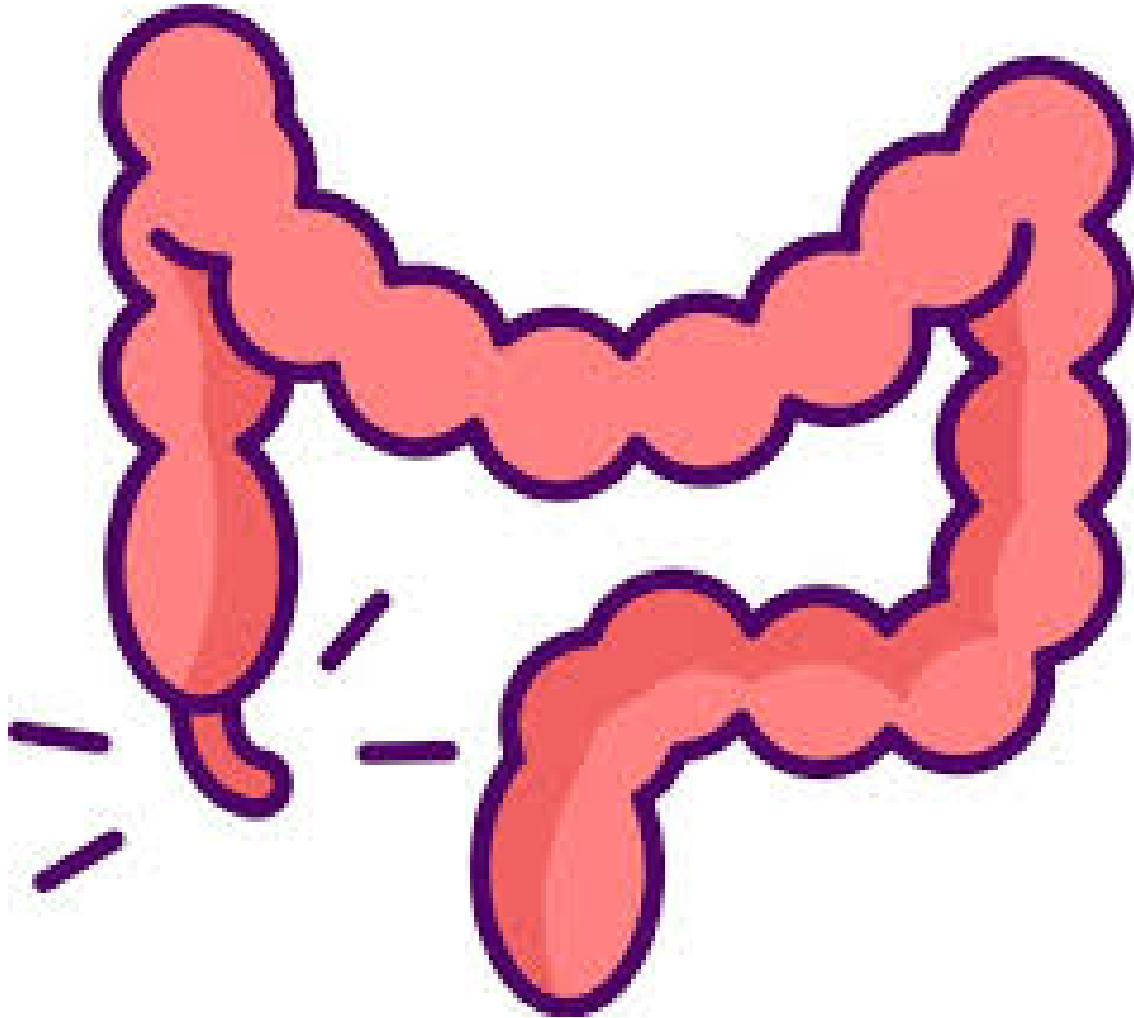
Fig. 5 Screenshot of the Indie Game Jam's Calendar

Indie Game Jams Repository - <https://indiegamejams.com/> -

Do game jams! They are fun! This is a repository of a ton of game jams, which you can choose from. Any other game jam will do, but this has quite a few online ones to choose from. The important part is just making many small projects as Tyler Glaiel writes.

Appendix

(More Resources)



This appendix offers a few recommendations and sources for finding internships and scholarships.

Scholarships - <https://www.aiasfoundation.org/> -

The AIAS foundation has a few good scholarship opportunities, but in general scholarships in the video game industry are usually fairly personal and you should put more research into it if you want them.

bigfuture.collegeboard.org/scholarship-search -

A repository of scholarships that you can narrow down by who you are to get many scholarships, for example, here is a few that I found:

- <https://bigfuture.collegeboard.org/scholarships/richard-w-pierce-scholarship> - Seniors (in High School) from Worcester County Massachusetts who are majoring in Game Design
- <https://bigfuture.collegeboard.org/scholarships/playstation-career-pathways-program> - HBCU sophomores majoring in creative game design.
- <https://www.theesa.com/foundation/computer-and-video-game-arts-and-sciences-scholarship/> - For women and people from underrepresented groups who are pursuing a career in game development, must be a high school senior through college junior.

scholarships.com/ and my.appily.com/scholarships -

I would recommend creating an account and finding applicable scholarships for yourself. The potential scholarships are different for everyone. Additionally, ask around your community to see if there are any scholarships there that might apply to a degree in game development.



Internships - Multiple links -

For game development, there is not a single way to get an internship. You might try to intern at a big game company like <https://www.epicgames.com/> or <https://careers.activision.com/> or <https://careers.nintendo.com/>. It is also completely possible to find an internship by looking at

your local game studios and asking them for an internship (even if they don't have one listed on their website). Making connections can lead to internships (because there are not many official small studio internships).